Surya Pugazhenthi

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Education

UC Santa Cruz — Santa Cruz, CA
Bachelor's of Science in Computer Science — *Sep. 2024 – June 2026*

Diablo Valley College — Pleasant Hill, CA
Associate's of Science in Computer Science — *Aug. 2022 – May 2024*

Experience

Venture Scout — Feb. – May 2026
LvlUp Ventures (Shopline-backed seed fund) — *Remote*

- **Sourced and evaluated pre-seed and seed-stage founders** by attending demo days (Afore Capital Spring 2026 Showcase, PearX W26) and identifying high-signal builders across B2B software and AI infrastructure.
- **Drafted personalized outreach emails** to 20+ founders, including Coverflow, Polarity, Hilt, Hexagon, and Clayzo. Converted 10 conversations into founder calls and secured 3 companies for potential investment.

Product Developer — Jan. 2025 – Jun. 2025
SlugAI, UC Santa Cruz — *Santa Cruz, CA*

- Defined product vision and strategy for ***Calendarize*** by conducting user interviews and market research. Authored comprehensive **PRD** and user story backlog.
- Implemented a **serverless analytics pipeline** (Next.js API route → PostHog) capturing **100%** of user interactions. Synthesized insights into **retention and funnel dashboards** used in weekly prioritization.
- Coordinated **cross-functional team** across design, engineering, and marketing to **launch Calendarize on Product Hunt.** Gathered feedback from early adopters to refine product positioning and roadmap.

Club President/Founder — Aug. 2023 – Dec. 2023
Product Development Club, Diablo Valley College — *Pleasant Hill, CA*

- Founded the college's **first product-focused club** from scratch, building community around students learning to build and ship real projects. Grew to **30+ active members** in a semester.

Projects

Nodegent | *Live in Production at nodegent.app* — Jun. 2026

- **Built and shipped a campus-aware AI assistant to production**, serving real UCSC students by answering course, housing, and registration queries through live institutional data retrieval.
- Engineered **Canvas + Google API** integrations with a **Playwright**-based SSO flow, wiring **Clerk** auth and **Groq LLM** server-side inference for secure, low-latency responses.
- Owned the full stack end to end across a 10-week sprint using **Next.js**, **TypeScript**, **Convex**, and **Vercel**, taking the product from zero to a live user base.

Credence | *Entrepreneur First Marketing Agents Hackathon* — Apr. 2026

- Placed **3rd for Best Use of Apify API**; built a **B2B prospect intelligence platform** scoring trust and fit for professionals across all high-stakes industries using real-time web scraping and configurable signal weighting.
- Architected full-stack pipeline using **React + Vite**, **Supabase** for real-time queries, and **Apify** to scrape and normalize prospect signals into a live scoring dashboard with connection graph visualization.

TripWeaver | *Locus (Y Combinator FW25) Agentic Payments Hackathon* — Nov. 2025

- **Won 2nd place and Stripe Prize Track**; built an autonomous business travel agent integrating **Stripe** and **x402 protocol** stablecoins for end-to-end trip booking and cross-border micropayments.
- Tech Stack: **Claude Agent SDK**, **Stripe API**, **Vercel/Next.js**, **Kiwi Travel MCP**, **Coinbase**, **Locus Crypto Wallet**.

Skills

Technical: Python (pandas, scikit-learn, NumPy), TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, FastAPI, Claude Agent SDK, Gemini API, Stripe API, Groq API, React, Vite, Next.js/Vercel, Convex, MongoDB, Supabase, Docker
Product & Strategy: PRD/spec writing, UI/UX design, Agile development
Tools: Claude Code, Git, Cursor/VS Code, PostHog Analytics, Figma, MCP Servers